
MT.GOX
2-11-5
WITHDRAWAL
PENDING
28 FEB 2014
850,000 BTC
REPORTED MISSING
2024

MT.GOX

024 / 28 FEB 2014 / BITCOIN / EPIC

WITHDRAWALS SUSPENDED.

On 28 February 2014, MtGox applied for civil rehabilitation at the Tokyo District Court. The exchange had closed its website three days earlier. Its announcement initially reported approximately 750,000 customer bitcoins and 100,000 of its own missing, while warning that the full extent was still under investigation. The card date marks the filing, not the first day withdrawals were suspended.

The 850,000 BTC headline was an initial report, not a final loss total. On 20 March, MtGox announced that it had located approximately 200,000 BTC in an old-format wallet on 7 March. The revised estimate of missing coins was about 650,000, still subject to investigation. For customers, the closed exchange became the beginning of a long claims process.

The artwork follows a fictional customer outside an imagined Mt.Gox building. Rain runs down his dark jacket and mustard scarf as he studies a letter; the red withdrawal panel and chained doors make his lack of access tangible. His red satchel hides an envelope marked 2024, a deliberate glimpse of the future rather than a period-accurate document. Card 094 returns to the same customer and street in sunshine ten years later. The two scenes connect the shock of the collapse with the eventual start of repayments, without suggesting that every loss was recovered.

DETAILS IN THE ART

01 The initial headline

The newspaper says 850,000 BTC REPORTED MISSING. This is the February 2014 estimate, before the later announcement that roughly 200,000 BTC had been found.

02 Withdrawal pending

The red panel holds the customer at WITHDRAWAL PENDING. It turns a blocked account into a visible warning, rather than reproducing a real MtGox terminal.

03 The chained doors

A chain and padlock join the door handles. They symbolise the closed exchange and remain in card 094: repayments do not mean MtGox reopened.

04 An envelope from the future

The 2024 envelope in the red satchel deliberately points forward to card 094. It is an editorial callback, not an authentic object from February 2014.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Sources: MtGox filing, 28 February 2014; Wallet update, 20 March 2014; Repayments, 5 July 2024. Fictional customer, building and correspondence; not documentary evidence. The caption is editorial, not a quotation. Details are drawn from the approved full artwork, with tiny labels not guaranteed legible at card size. Native art: 1060 x 1484; 128.21 effective PPI at A4. Physical print acceptance remains pending.